Topic 12: Integrating AI Tools into Your Workflow

12.1 Mapping AI to Your Work

- Step 1: list your 10 most time-consuming recurring tasks
- Step 2: for each, identify which AI tool could help and what the prompt would look like
- Step 3: pilot one task with AI for one week and note: time saved, quality of output, what needed editing
- Step 4: expand to additional tasks once the habit is established and the workflow is proven
- Step 5: share your workflow template with colleagues -- AI productivity scales across teams

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Example AI workflow map:

Task                     -> AI Tool
Draft weekly status      -> Claude / ChatGPT
Summarise meeting notes  -> Otter.ai + Notion AI
Debug code               -> GitHub Copilot + Claude
Research a topic         -> Perplexity AI
Create presentation      -> ChatGPT + Canva AI
Reply to emails          -> Outlook Copilot / Gmail Gemini
Generate social posts    -> ChatGPT with saved template prompt
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12.2 Building a Prompt Library

- Save prompts that produce consistently good results -- in Notion, Obsidian, or a simple text file
- Organise by task type: writing, coding, analysis, research, summarisation, email
- Include: the model used, any special instructions, sample output, and date last tested
- Share with your team: a shared prompt library multiplies individual productivity across the organisation
- Iterate: when you find a better version of a prompt, update the library and note what changed

12.3 AI Automation with No-Code Tools

- Zapier (zapier.com): trigger AI actions when events happen -- 'new support ticket -> AI draft reply -> email to agent'
- Make.com: visual workflow builder with native ChatGPT and Claude integration for more complex pipelines
- n8n (n8n.io): open-source workflow automation with AI nodes -- self-host for data privacy
- Use case example: every new customer review -> AI classifies sentiment and topic -> adds row to tracking spreadsheet

- No-code automation allows powerful AI workflows without writing a single line of code

12.4 Measuring Impact

- Track time before and after AI adoption on specific tasks -- even informal tracking reveals real savings
- Quality indicators: fewer revisions needed, higher stakeholder satisfaction, reduced error rates
- Volume: how much more can you produce in the same time? Compare output per day/week
- Note: productivity gains are real but variable -- they depend heavily on the task type and your AI skill level
- Share concrete results with leadership to justify AI tool subscriptions and team training